🏫 FOR TEACHER USE

# SWIM & WATER SAFETY TEACHER RESOURCE GUIDE

A complete unit resource for Health & Physical Education teachers in Victorian secondary schools. Includes lesson plans, answer keys, teaching notes, assessment rubrics, and curriculum alignment.

📅 Year 7–8

📚 HPE · Safety Focus Area

📋 4–6 Lessons (~50 min each)

🎓 Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0

📍 Victorian Secondary School Context

TEACHER RESOURCE GUIDE

## 📋 Contents



# 📌 1. Curriculum Alignment

### Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0 — Health & Physical Education

Victorian government and Catholic schools must implement Curriculum 2.0 from 2026. Swimming and water safety is a **mandated priority area** alongside respectful relationships, embedded across both HPE strands.

| Content Description | Code | Strand | How This Unit Addresses It |
|---|---|---|---|
| Plan and implement strategies, using health resources, to enhance their own and others' health, safety, relationships and wellbeing | VC2HP8P10 | Personal, Social & Community Health | Students investigate water safety strategies and evaluate their effectiveness for Victorian contexts |
| Plan and implement strategies, using health resources, to enhance their own and others' health, safety, relationships and wellbeing | VC2HP8P10 | Personal, Social & Community Health | Students develop personal action plans and community awareness activities around drowning prevention |
| Investigate how media and influential people in the community impact attitudes, beliefs, decisions and behaviours in relation to health, safety, relationships and wellbeing | VC2HP8P09 | Personal, Social & Community Health | Students analyse LSV drowning data and evaluate the credibility of health/safety information sources |
| Refine and perform specialised movement skills in aquatic environments | VC2HP8M01 | Movement & Physical Activity | Students apply survival swimming and rescue techniques in pool sessions (partner unit) |
| Refine protective behaviours and evaluate community resources to seek help for themselves and others (including basic first aid and CPR) | VC2HP8P08 | Personal, Social & Community Health | Students identify social barriers (peer pressure) to safe decisions near water |

### 🎯 Focus Areas (Victorian Curriculum 2.0)

- **Safety (S)** — Core: safe practices near and in water, emergency response, recognising hazards
- **Lifelong Physical Activities (LPA)** — Swimming as a lifelong health-enhancing skill
- **Fundamental Movement Skills (FMS)** — Aquatic movement and survival skills

### 📊 Achievement Standard Connections — Levels 7 & 8

By the end of Level 8, students are expected to:

- Investigate strategies that enhance their own and others' health, safety and wellbeing
- Justify actions that promote their own and others' health, safety and wellbeing in community contexts
- Gather and analyse health information to make informed decisions
- Explain personal and social skills required to establish respectful relationships and promote inclusivity
- Demonstrate control and accuracy when performing specialised movement skills

**Source:** https://f10.vcaa.vic.edu.au/health-and-physical-education/curriculum/f-10

## 🗺 2. Unit Overview & Learning Intentions

### 📐 Unit Overview

| Element | Detail |
|---|---|
| Unit Title | Swim & Water Safety: Making Smart Choices in Victorian Waters |
| Year Level | Year 7–8 (Ages 12–14) |
| Duration | 4–6 × 50-minute lessons (can be expanded for swimming carnival unit) |
| Setting | Fully classroom-based / dry-land (no pool required) + optional pool/excursion component |
| Key Resources | Student workbook (Sections 1–6), Poster pack (4 posters), Scenario activity cards (14 cards), Assessment gradebook, Resource directory, internet access for research tasks |
| Partner Organisations | Life Saving Victoria (LSV), RLSSA Swim & Survive, Paddle Australia, Parks Victoria, VCAA, DE, St John Ambulance Victoria |
| Prerequisite Knowledge | Basic swimming at primary level; Victorian Water Safety Certificate (Foundation–Year 6) |
| Dry-land Suitability | ✅ All activities in this unit can be delivered without water access — explicitly supported by Victorian Curriculum 2.0 and LSV Toolkit |

### ✅ Learning Intentions — What students will know, understand and be able to do:

| KNOW (Knowledge) | UNDERSTAND (Conceptual) | DO (Skills) |
|---|---|---|

- Current Victorian drowning statistics
- Beach flag system and meanings
- DRS ABCD action plan
- LSV SwimSafe 5 rules
- What a rip current is
- Cold water shock effects
- Key risk factors for young people
- Throw rescue hierarchy

- Why unpatrolled locations are more dangerous
- Why young males are overrepresented in drowning data
- How peer pressure influences risky decisions near water
- Why alcohol and water is a deadly combination
- The relationship between knowledge, skills and safety outcomes

- Apply DRS ABCD in a simulated emergency
- Analyse and interpret drowning data
- Make and justify safe decisions in water scenarios
- Rank and demonstrate throw rescue equipment choices
- Map hazards across different Victorian water environments
- Create a water safety communication product for a real audience
- Locate patrolled beaches using the BeachSafe app

## 💬 Essential Questions

- *Why does Victoria have such a high drowning rate compared to its population size?*
- *What decisions, information and skills could prevent most Victorian drowning deaths?*
- *How do social factors (peer pressure, gender norms, overconfidence) increase risk near water?*
- *What is my personal responsibility to be water safe and to help keep others safe?*
- *Why are rivers and inland waterways just as dangerous — or more so — than the beach?*

## 🏛 Partner Organisations — Reference Table

This unit draws on best-practice frameworks from the following organisations. All are free to access for Victorian teachers.

| Organisation | Primary Use in This Unit | Key URL |
|---|---|---|
| **Life Saving Victoria (LSV)** | SwimSafe rules, annual drowning data, classroom lessons, multicultural resources, LSV Toolkit | `https://lsv.com.au`<br>`https://lsv.com.au/toolkit/classroom_based_water_safety.php` |
| **RLSSA — Swim and Survive** | Dry-land classroom modules, Bronze e-Lifesaving (risk-taking, peer pressure, alcohol), throw rescue guidelines | `https://www.royallifesaving.com.au`<br>`https://www.drowningprevention.org.au/swimandsurvive` |
| **VCAA** | Curriculum 2.0 content descriptions, achievement standards, sample swimming activities F–10 | `https://f10.vcaa.vic.edu.au`<br>`https://www.vcaa.vic.edu.au/curriculum/foundation-10/curriculum-area-resources/health-and-physical-education/teaching-resources` |
| **Victorian Dept of Education** | Swimming policy, funding, toolkit, excursion guidelines | `https://www2.education.vic.gov.au/pal/swimming-instruction-and-water-safety-education/policy` |
| **Paddle Australia** | Inland waterway safety — rivers, lakes, moving water; relevant to Yarra, Goulburn, Alpine regions | `https://paddle.org.au` |
| **Parks Victoria** | Natural waterway hazard awareness; localised Victorian scenarios for classroom use | `https://www.park.vic.gov.au` |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **AUSTSWIM** | Teacher training frameworks; lesson progression models; inclusion strategies | `https://austswim.com.au` |
| **St John Ambulance Vic** | DRS ABCD, CPR, first aid resources; free printable guides for classroom use | `https://www.stjohnvic.com.au/first-aid-resources/` |
| **BeachSafe (SLSA)** | Student research task: find nearest patrolled beaches; check conditions and patrol times | `https://beachsafe.org.au` |
| **American Red Cross** | "Think So You Don't Sink" decision-making model; engaging videos for secondary students | `https://www.redcross.org/take-a-class/water-safety` |
| **CDC Drowning Prevention (USA)** | International data for numeracy/cross-curricular comparison tasks; risk factor research | `https://www.cdc.gov/drowning/prevention` |

### 💧 Best-Practice Dry-Land Teaching Approaches

This unit is **fully deliverable without water access**. The following approaches are drawn from LSV, RLSSA, and AUSTSWIM best practice for no-pool environments:

| Approach | How It's Used in This Unit | Key Resource |
|---|---|---|
| **Scenario-Based Learning** | 14 printable Scenario Cards covering beach, river, pool, emergency, and decision-making contexts. All Victorian settings. | Scenario Activity Cards (separate file) |
| **Role Play & Simulation** | Throw rescue with towels/ropes (L3); 000 call role-play; DRS ABCD sequencing on mats | Lesson 3 plan; Workbook Section 3 |
| **Hazard Mapping** | Students analyse beach, river, and pool environments to identify and rank hazards by risk level | Workbook Activity 4.0 |
| **Data Analysis (Numeracy)** | LSV 2023–24 drowning data; calculate percentages by age group, location, gender | Workbook Sections 1, 5; Extension Card X1 |
| **Decision-Making Models** | SwimSafe rules (LSV), throw rescue hierarchy (RLSSA), "Think So You Don't Sink" (Red Cross) | Workbook Sections 4, 5; Poster 4 |
| **Communication Tasks (Literacy)** | Three-option campaign task: social media post, letter to younger student, or multilingual fact sheet | Workbook Activity 6.2; Scenario Card X2 |

📌 RECOMMENDED "BEST COMBO" FOR VICTORIAN SCHOOLS

**Core:** Life Saving Victoria (LSV Toolkit) as your primary source — local, curriculum-aligned, free. **Structure:** RLSSA Swim and Survive classroom modules for lesson sequencing. **Compliance:** Victorian DE + VCAA for documentation. **Enhance with:** Paddle Australia for inland waterway content, Red Cross videos for student engagement, Parks Vic for localised Victorian scenarios.

## 📋 3. Lesson Plans

L1

# Victoria's Drowning Crisis — Why It Matters to You

⏱ 50 min | 📖 Workbook Sections 1 | 🎯 VC2HP8P10, VC2HP8P09 | 🏫 Classroom

🔥 ENGAGE — 10 MIN

### Opening Hook — "Could This Be You?"

- Begin with the question on the board: *"Name the THREE closest bodies of water to where you live."*
- Brief think-pair-share (2 min), then gather responses. Map on the whiteboard if possible.
- Show the statistic: **"In 2023–24, 54 people drowned in Victoria. All deaths happened at unpatrolled locations. Nearly 1 in 5 were aged 15–24."**
- Ask: *"What does this make you feel? Were you surprised? Why or why not?"*

🔍 EXPLORE — 15 MIN

### Data Investigation

- Students complete Workbook Activity 1.1 (personal connection survey) independently — 5 min.
- Students examine the data table in Activity 1.2 and complete the 'What does this tell us?' column — 8 min.
- If internet available: students visit https://lsv.com.au/research/victorian-drowning-reports/ to cross-reference data.

📣 EXPLAIN — 15 MIN

### Teacher-Led Discussion: Why Teenagers Are at Risk

- Walk through the key risk factors using Poster 3 as a visual reference (display on projector or print A3).
- Discuss: peer pressure, risk-taking during adolescence, gender and risk-taking behaviour, cultural background, overconfidence.
- Key teacher talking point: *"The reason this unit is important is not because any of you are irresponsible — it's because the research shows that the circumstances leading to drowning often come up quickly, in social settings, exactly like where you go in summer."*

✏️ ELABORATE — 8 MIN

### Written Responses (Questions 1.2a and 1.2b)

- Students complete Questions 1.2a and 1.2b in their workbooks independently.
- Circulate to check understanding. Prompt students who are struggling with: *"Look at the data about WHERE drownings happen. What does that tell you?"*

📝 EVALUATE / EXIT — 5 MIN

### Exit Ticket

- On a sticky note or scrap of paper: *"Write ONE fact from today that surprised you and ONE question you still have."*
- Collect at the door. Use questions to guide Lesson 2 content.

📌 PEDAGOGICAL NOTES

- Avoid dramatising drowning deaths. The goal is empowerment through information, not fear. Keep a calm, factual tone.
- Be aware that some students may have had personal experience with drowning-related loss. Brief students at the start that if anything feels too personal, they can step out or talk to you privately.
- The gender discussion (males are 4× more likely to drown) is a strong discussion point — connect to broader HPE themes around gender norms, risk-taking, and social pressure. Handle sensitively.

⚠️ **Pastoral Care Note:** If any student discloses distress related to a drowning incident in their family or community, follow your school's wellbeing support protocols immediately. Have wellbeing referral information available before running this lesson.

L2

# Beach Flags, Signals & Rip Current Survival

⏱ 50 min | 📖 Workbook Section 2 | 🎯 VC2HP8P10 | 🏫 Classroom

🔥 ENGAGE — 8 MIN

### Flag Quiz — Prior Knowledge Probe

- Show images of 6 beach flags (from Poster 2 or online) on the projector — no labels.
- Students write on mini-whiteboards or paper: what does each one mean?
- Quick show of hands: *"Who has ever swum at a patrolled beach? Who always swims between the flags?"*
- Validate correct answers, address misconceptions immediately.

🔍 EXPLORE — 12 MIN

### Flag Identification Activity (Workbook 2.1)

- Students complete Activity 2.1 flag identification in workbooks independently.
- Then peer-check with a partner using Poster 2 as a reference.
- Whole-class share: which flag did most students get wrong? Discuss why.

📣 EXPLAIN — 12 MIN

### Rip Currents — Teacher Explanation with Diagram

- Use the rip current diagram in the student workbook (projected on screen) to explain how rip currents form, how to identify them, and how to escape.
- Key analogy: *"A rip current is like a conveyor belt in the ocean taking you away from shore. You can't run against a conveyor belt — you step sideways off it."*
- Watch: Surf Life Saving Australia's rip current video: https://sls.com.au/surf-safety/rip-currents/ (approx 3–4 min)

✏️ ELABORATE — 12 MIN

### Scenario Analysis — Liam's Story (Activity 2.2) + Scenario Cards

- Students read the Liam scenario and answer questions 2.2a–c in their workbooks.
- Encourage students to use specific vocabulary: rip current, patrolled beach, parallel to shore, conserve energy.
- **Optional station rotation:** Use **Scenario Cards B1** (Unpatrolled Beach), **B2** (Caught in a Rip), and **B3** (The Flag Problem) from the Scenario Activity Card pack. Groups rotate every 8 minutes. Cards include teacher answer reveals — display on screen only, not student copies.

📝 EVALUATE — 6 MIN

### BeachSafe App Demo + SwimSafe Rules Introduction

- Demonstrate BeachSafe at https://beachsafe.org.au — show students how to find their nearest patrolled beach.
- Task: *"Find the three nearest patrolled beaches to your home using BeachSafe."* (homework or now if devices available)
- Preview next lesson: display **Poster 4 (SwimSafe Rules)** on projector. Quick verbal run-through of the 5 rules — students will do the full activity next lesson.

📌 EXTENSION ACTIVITY

Have students use Google Maps and BeachSafe to identify the nearest *unpatrolled* swimming spot to their home and list three hazards it might have. This brings the data to life for their own geography. Extension Card X1 (Data Analysis) can also be assigned at this point.

L3

# Emergency Response — DRS ABCD & Rescue Skills

⏱ 50 min | 📖 Workbook Section 3 | 🎯 VC2HP8P10 | 🏫 Classroom + Practical

🔥 ENGAGE — 5 MIN

### DRS ABCD — Reveal Game

- 7 chairs at the front, numbered 1–7. Each chair has a letter card face down (D, R, S, A, B, C, D).
- Ask 7 volunteers to come up and flip their cards. Class guesses the word for each letter.
- Award house points for correct answers to build engagement.

🔍 EXPLORE — 15 MIN

### CPR Demonstration + Practice

- Use a CPR manikin (or demonstrate hand placement on a cushion/rolled-up mat).
- Demonstrate: head tilt-chin lift, check breathing (10 seconds), chest compressions (30 at 100–120 bpm, depth 5–6cm for adults), 2 rescue breaths.
- Students practise compressions in pairs on cushions/mats — emphasise: *"Harder than you think — don't be afraid to push."*
- **Hands-only CPR is acceptable and encouraged if students are uncomfortable with rescue breaths.**

🔔 EXPLAIN — 8 MIN

### Throw Rescue Technique

- Demonstrate throw rescue: *throw the rope/towel so it lands PAST the person, so they can grab the floating end as it drifts back.*
- Practise with a coiled rope or a bundle of towels (classroom version: scrunched t-shirt).
- Key message: *"You do NOT need to enter the water. A throw rescue can save a life from the bank."*

✏️ ELABORATE — 15 MIN

### Workbook Activities 3.1 and 3.2 + Scenario Cards

- Students complete DRS ABCD table (Activity 3.1) and River Rope Swing scenario (Activity 3.2) in pairs.
- Discussion prompt: *"What is the FIRST thing you do before approaching someone who is injured?"* (Check for danger — too often people rush in and become casualties themselves.)
- **Scenario Cards E1** (Calling 000) and **E2** (Throw Rescue) from the Scenario Activity Card pack work well as pair/group follow-on tasks here. Card E2 directly reinforces the RLSSA throw rescue hierarchy from Activity 5.2 in the workbook.

📝 EVALUATE — 7 MIN

### Role-Play Check

- One pair at a time (or selected pairs) role-play calling 000 using the DRS ABCD sequence.
- One person is the caller; teacher plays dispatcher. Other students observe and provide feedback.

⚠️ **Practical Safety:** Ensure CPR practice surfaces are appropriate. Students with known cardiac conditions or injuries should be excused from physical compression practice but can observe and answer theory questions. Do not allow students to perform actual mouth-to-mouth on each other — use manikins or hands-only CPR for this lesson.

📌 NOTE ON CALLING 000

Remind students: when calling 000, say your location clearly (street address or nearest intersection), what happened, how many people are injured, and whether the person is breathing. Stay on the line — the operator will guide you through what to do next.

📌 RLSSA THROW RESCUE HIERARCHY

The Royal Life Saving Society Australia (RLSSA) recommend this rescue priority order: **(1) Talk** — shout instructions from safety; **(2) Reach** — extend something from the bank (pole, towel, clothing); **(3) Throw** — throw a buoyant object with a line; **(4) Row** — use a vessel if available; **(5) Go** — enter the water only if trained, never alone, always with a flotation device. Workbook Activity 5.2 asks students to apply this hierarchy. Source: https://www.royallifesaving.com.au

## L4 Hazard Mapping, Safe Decisions, Inland Waterways & Alcohol

⏱ 50 min | 📖 Workbook Sections 4–5 | 🎯 VC2HP8P08, VC2HP8P10 | 🏫 Classroom

### 🔥 ENGAGE — 8 MIN

**"Would You?" — Values Clarification**

- Read out scenarios. Students stand on one side of the room for "I would do it" and the other for "I wouldn't."
- Scenarios: *"Your 5 best friends dare you to jump off a cliff into a lake — it looks safe from above." / "It's 38°C and you're at a river, your friends are all swimming, and there's no lifeguard. You would…" / "You're at a party near a pool and a friend dares you to swim across even though you've been drinking."*
- After each: discuss WHY they chose their side. No judgment — this is a discussion, not an assessment.
- These directly mirror **Scenario Cards D1** (The Group Decision) and **D2** (Alcohol & Water) — which can be used as written follow-on tasks for this activity.

### 🔍 EXPLORE — 15 MIN

**Hazard Mapping (Activity 4.0) + SwimSafe Rules (Workbook Section 4)**

- Students complete **Activity 4.0 Hazard Mapping** — identifying and ranking hazards across beach, river/dam, and pool environments. Groups of 2–3 work well.
- Introduce the **LSV SwimSafe 5 Rules** using Poster 4. Ask students to copy the rules into their workbook Section 4 key knowledge box, then apply them to their hazard table responses.
- Whole-class debrief: Which environment is most dangerous? Why do rivers and dams account for so many Victorian drowning deaths? (Refer to LSV data — https://lsv.com.au/research/victorian-drowning-reports/)

### 📣 EXPLAIN — 10 MIN

**Inland Waterways + Cold Water Shock — Victorian Context**

- Explain cold water shock: involuntary gasp reflex, hyperventilation, sudden heart rate increase, muscle incapacitation.
- Victorian context: *"Alpine lakes like Lake Eildon are fed by snowmelt. Even in December they can sit at 12–15°C. Your body reacts within seconds of entering cold water — even in summer."*
- Reference **Paddle Australia** for river and moving-water safety: https://paddle.org.au — particularly relevant for students in Yarra Valley, Gippsland, or Alpine regions.
- Reference **Parks Victoria** (https://www.park.vic.gov.au) for localised Victorian waterway hazard information students can research independently.
- **Scenario Cards R2** (After the Rain) and **R3** (Cold Water Shock) work well here as 5-minute quick writes or partner discussion tasks.

### ✏️ ELABORATE — 12 MIN

**Activities 4.1, 5.1, 5.2, 5.3, 5.4 + Risk vs Benefit**

- Students complete the **Risk vs. Benefit Analysis table (4.1)** and Question 4.1a (peer pressure strategy) in pairs.
- Students complete **Activity 5.2 Throw Rescue ranking** — reinforces the RLSSA rescue hierarchy. Debrief: why is "jumping in" consistently ranked last?
- Students complete **Activity 5.3 Alcohol and Water** — this can be sensitive for some students. Normalise by framing it as a public health fact: *"Alcohol is mentioned in drowning reports every year — this is about understanding the risk, not making judgements."*
- Encourage authentic, specific action plans — not generic. Prompt: *"What will YOU actually do differently this summer?"*
- Students complete **Activity 5.4 — Diving, Shallow Water & Spinal Injury**. See teacher note below for delivery guidance and key statistics.

**Activity 5.4 — Diving, Shallow Water & Spinal Injury (new)**

This activity was added to address a significant gap in the original unit — diving and shallow-water spinal injury is the primary catastrophic risk for students in the 10–14 age group, yet it receives far less classroom attention than drowning. The three 2024–25 Australian case studies make this immediately relevant.

**Key data to know before teaching:**

- Unsafe diving = **10%** of all spinal cord injuries and **20%** of quadriplegia cases in Australia (AIHW)
- **95%** of aquatic spinal injury patients are male — **highest incidence age group: 10–14 years**
- Cervical vertebrae (C4–C6) fracture on head-first impact — spinal cord neurons cannot regenerate — **two-thirds** suffer permanent disability
- Three 2024–25 case studies: **Terrigal Wharf NSW** (shallow tidal water beneath wharf), **Torquay Front Beach VIC** (shifting sandbank at surf beach), **Bawley Beach NSW** (sandbank formed between visits — false confidence)

**Teaching approach:**

- Cold-open: display the six-stat data block (10%, 20%, 95%, 66%, 10–14, +34%) without context. Ask: *"What do you think these numbers describe?"* — consistently produces strong engagement because students are surprised it is not about drowning.
- Read the three case studies as a class. For each, ask: *"What specifically changed between the last safe visit and this injury?"* — lead students to the mechanism (sandbank, tidal variation, wharf depth) rather than just "they made a bad decision."
- Q5.4a asks students to reflect on their own risk — particularly for male students aged 10–14. Frame this as self-awareness, not accusation: *"The data describes a pattern — your job is to understand whether it applies to you and why."*
- **Sensitivity note:** some students may have personal connections to these injuries. Brief the class that the content involves real injuries before showing the statistics.
- Sources to cite: AIHW (aihw.gov.au), Royal Perth Hospital spinal injury review, RLSSA (royallifesaving.com.au)

📝 EVALUATE — 5 MIN

**Gallery Walk — SwimSafe Commitment**

- Students share the SwimSafe rule they identified as most important for them (Workbook 6.1b) with a partner and explain their reasoning.
- Optional: post sticky notes on a class board under each of the 5 SwimSafe rules — which rule does the class think is most critical?

📌 PADDLE AUSTRALIA — CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Paddle Australia's safety resources are free and web-accessible. For students in regional Victoria, connecting water safety to specific local rivers (Yarra, Goulburn, Ovens, Mitchell) makes this content highly relevant. For Workbook Activity 5.1c, students visiting paddle.org.au will find river grading systems, water hazard descriptions, and safety checklists — excellent for the research task.

## L5 Assessment + Community Action — Communication Campaign

⏱ 50 min | 📖 Workbook Section 6 | 🎯 VC2HP8P09, VC2HP8P10 | 🏫 Classroom

🔥 ENGAGE — 8 MIN

**Review Quiz + Scenario Card Showdown**

- Quick Kahoot or Quizlet revision quiz (5 min) covering beach flags, DRS ABCD, SwimSafe rules, rip current escape, and Victorian statistics.
- Optional 3-min rapid fire: project one scenario card (e.g. **Card R1** or **P1**) — whole class calls out the correct action. Teacher confirms using the answer reveal. High engagement, low prep.

✏️ ELABORATE — 30 MIN

**Assessment Task: Water Safety Communication Campaign (Workbook Activity 6.2)**

Students choose ONE of three options from the workbook (all options are now built into the workbook):

- **Option A — Social media post** for teenagers (Instagram/TikTok style, 1–2 slides). Must include a statistic with source URL and a call to action. Mirrors **Extension Scenario Card X2**.
- **Option B — Letter to a Year 5 student** (approx. 200 words) explaining three things they must know about water safety in Victoria before summer.
- **Option C (Extension) — Multilingual community fact sheet** about beach flags and Victorian waterway dangers for someone new to Australia. Strongly recommended for CALD students — encourage use of home language. This directly addresses the finding that CALD communities account for ~40% of Victorian drowning deaths.

**Teacher tip:** Encourage students to cite LSV, Parks Victoria, or Paddle Australia as sources — this reinforces the research literacy skill from VC2HP8P09.

📝 EVALUATE 12 MIN

**Workbook Collection + Self-Assessment + Peer Share**

- Students complete the self-assessment checklist (now 8 criteria) on the back of their workbook.
- Optional: students share their campaign product with a partner — 2 min each. Partner gives one piece of feedback: *"One thing that would make this more persuasive is…"*
- Collect completed workbooks for teacher marking using the Assessment Gradebook rubric.

📌 CROSS-CURRICULAR OPPORTUNITIES

- **English/Literacy:** Option B (letter) directly develops persuasive writing and audience awareness skills
- **Mathematics:** Encourage all options to calculate or convert statistics (e.g. "1 in 5 = 20%" or "non-fatal drownings were 60% above average")
- **Languages:** Option C multilingual task is ideal for Languages classes to co-develop
- **Geography:** The action plan (6.1c) kayaking option links to Paddle Australia and Victorian river geography

## 🔑 4. Student Workbook — Answer Key

### 🔑 Section 1: Victorian Drowning Statistics

ACTIVITY 1.2 — Data Table (What does this tell us?) interpretive — accept variety

***54 deaths:*** *Victoria's drowning rate in 2023–24 was the highest in over a decade, suggesting the problem is getting worse, not better.*
***1 in 5 aged 15–24:*** *Young people are significantly overrepresented, meaning age alone isn't protective — young people drown too.*
***46 of 54 male:*** *Males take more physical risks near water, often influenced by peer pressure or overconfidence in their abilities.*
***All at unpatrolled sites:*** *If everyone swam only at patrolled locations, the death toll could theoretically be near zero.*

Q 1.2a — TWO reasons teenagers are at higher risk (2 marks) 1 mark per valid reason

*Accept any two of: risk-taking behaviour common in adolescence; peer pressure to swim in unsafe places; overconfidence in swimming ability; tendency to swim at unpatrolled locations; lack of awareness of hidden dangers like rip currents or cold water; social norms around not 'backing down' from dares.*

Q 1.2b — What unpatrolled location data suggests (2 marks)

*Model answer: The fact that all drownings occurred at unpatrolled locations suggests that trained lifeguards and supervision are extremely effective at preventing drowning deaths. Swimming at patrolled beaches/pools dramatically reduces risk because someone is watching and able to respond in seconds. This makes swimming at patrolled locations one of the single most important things people can do to stay safe.*

### 🔑 Section 2: Beach Flags & Rip Currents

Activity 2.1 — Flag Identification

*Flag 1: Red & Yellow — Patrolled swimming area; always swim here*
*Flag 2: Red — Dangerous conditions; experienced swimmers only or do not enter*
*Flag 3: Black & White Quartered — Surfboards/watercraft zone; swimmers stay out*
*Flag 4: Yellow + Black Ball — No surfboards; swimming only in this zone*
*Flag 5: Orange Windsock — Offshore winds; no inflatables allowed*
*Flag 6: Purple — Dangerous marine life spotted; swim with caution*

Q 2.2a — THREE steps if caught in a rip (3 marks, 1 per valid step)

*1. Stay calm and don't panic — conserve energy.*
*2. Float or tread water rather than fighting the current.*
*3. Swim parallel to the shore (not directly in) to escape the current's channel, then angle back to shore. If unable to reach shore, raise one arm and call/signal for help.*

`Q 2.2b — Why swimming directly against a rip is dangerous (2 marks)`

*A rip current can move at speeds up to 2.5 m/s — faster than most swimmers can sprint. Swimming directly against it uses enormous energy very quickly, leading to exhaustion and then drowning. The swimmer makes no progress against the current, becomes panicked, and loses the ability to stay afloat.*

`Q 2.2c — Liam's scenario: TWO mistakes and what should have been done (4 marks)`

*Mistake 1: Swimming at an unpatrolled beach. They should have gone to a patrolled beach where lifeguards could respond within seconds.*
*Mistake 2: Liam tried to swim directly against the rip current, exhausting himself. He should have stayed calm, floated, swum parallel to shore, and if needed, raised his arm to signal for help.*
*Bonus: His friends didn't know what to do — they should have known to call 000 immediately and throw something that floats rather than entering the water themselves.*

## 🔑 Section 3: DRS ABCD

`Activity 3.1 — DRS ABCD words`

*D — DANGER | R — RESPONSE | S — SEND (for help / call 000) | A — AIRWAY | B — BREATHING | C — CPR | D — DEFIBRILLATION*

`Q 3.2a — First action at River Rope Swing (2 marks)`

*First action: Do NOT jump in. Call 000 (or shout for someone else to call while you act). Then use the rope from the swing to throw to the person (throw rescue). This is safer than entering water and risking becoming another casualty. The rope from the swing is already available.*

`Q 3.2b — Why the friend jumping in was dangerous (2 marks)`

*The untrained friend who jumped in creates a second casualty risk. When a person is drowning, they involuntarily grab anything within reach (including the rescuer) and may push the rescuer underwater in their panic. Without rescue training, entering the water dramatically increases the chance of two drownings, not one.*

## 🔑 Section 4: SwimSafe Rules, Hazard Mapping & Decision-Making

`Activity 4.0 — Hazard Mapping Table` `accept well-reasoned responses`

***Beach (patrolled):*** *Rip currents (H), sunburn/heat illness (M), jellyfish (M), rough surf/waves (H), swimming outside flags (H). Safe: swim between flags, check conditions, sun protection.*
***River/Dam:*** *Cold water shock (H), submerged objects/debris (H), strong currents especially after rain (H), no lifeguard (H), unknown depth (H). Safe: enter feet first, never swim alone, check weather/conditions, wear lifejacket for boating.*
***Pool:*** *Unsupervised young children (H), diving into shallow end (H), drains (M), glass near pool (L), no adult supervision (H). Safe: always watch children, no diving in shallow water, pool fencing.*

`Q 4.0a — Most dangerous environment + evidence (2 marks)`

*Model answer: Rivers and dams are the most dangerous overall. The LSV 2023–24 data shows all 54 Victorian drowning deaths occurred at unpatrolled locations, and inland waterways (rivers, dams, lakes) accounted for the majority of these. Unlike patrolled beaches, rivers have no lifeguard supervision, cold water shock risk, hidden currents, submerged hazards, and conditions that change rapidly (especially after rain). Accept any well-argued response supported by data.*

`Activity 4 — LSV SwimSafe 5 Rules (from memory)`

*1. Read signs · 2. Enter feet first · 3. Stay in depth · 4. Swim with a friend · 5. Signal for help*
*Source: Life Saving Victoria — https://lsv.com.au*

### Section 5: Inland Waterways, Throw Rescue & Alcohol

Activity 5.2 — Throw Rescue Ranking (RLSSA hierarchy) — accept logical reasoning

*Best to worst: **1. Life ring attached to jetty** — attached, won't sink, can be pulled back; **2. Coiled rope/throw bag** — can throw to distance and pull person in; **3. Extending towel/clothing from bank** — limited reach, only effective if person is close; **4. Throwing pool noodle/esky lid** — buoyant but no line to pull person in; **5. Jumping in** — most dangerous option, should only be done by trained rescuers with a flotation device. Award marks for reasoning, not just ranking order.*
*Source: RLSSA Talk → Reach → Throw → Row → Go hierarchy — https://www.royallifesaving.com.au*

Q 5.3a — THREE ways alcohol increases drowning risk (3 marks, 1 per valid effect)

*Accept any three of: impaired judgement (overestimates swimming ability, takes more risks); reduced coordination (can't swim effectively); slowed reaction time (slower to respond to danger); impaired body temperature regulation (increases hypothermia risk in cold water); reduced ability to hold breath; false confidence leading to swimming in unsafe locations or depths.*

Q 5.3b — TWO specific risks in pool party alcohol scenario (2 marks)

*Accept any two of: night-time swimming means poor visibility — harder to see if person goes under; alcohol impairs the ability to assess depth or distance; CPR/rescue response is complicated by the alcohol use of bystanders; a person who goes unconscious in the water at night may not be noticed; alcohol-affected friends are less likely to identify an emergency quickly and respond correctly. Accept well-reasoned alternatives.*

## 5. Assessment Strategies & Rubric

### Assessment Overview — Formative & Summative

| Task | Type | Timing | Worth |
|---|---|---|---|
| Exit tickets (Lessons 1, 2, 3) | Formative | End of each lesson | Ungraded — teacher feedback |
| Student workbook (Sections 1–6, including new Activities 4.0, 5.2, 5.3) | Summative | Collected end of unit | 40% of unit grade (teacher's discretion) |
| CPR / rescue role-play observation | Formative practical | Lesson 3 | Teacher observation checklist |
| Communication campaign task (Workbook Activity 6.2 — Options A, B, or C) | Summative | Lesson 5 / homework | 60% of unit grade (teacher's discretion) |

See the separate **Assessment Gradebook** file for the full A–E rubric with 7 criteria, editable class tracker, and report comment generator.

### Workbook Marking Rubric

A full 7-criteria A–E rubric with report comment generator is in the separate **Assessment Gradebook** file. This abbreviated rubric (E/C/A) is suitable for quick marking and oral feedback.

| Criteria | E (Emerging) | C (Consolidating) | A (Achieving) |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Knowledge of water safety facts and statistics** | Limited or inaccurate facts; relies on general statements | Accurate facts from class/workbook; some elaboration | Accurate, well-chosen facts with elaboration; references to LSV data; demonstrates genuine understanding |
| **Hazard mapping & risk assessment** (Activity 4.0) | Names only obvious hazards; no ranking or explanation | Identifies key hazards across most environments; some explanation of risk level | Systematically identifies and ranks hazards; explains specific mechanisms of danger; supports reasoning with Victorian context or data |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **LSV SwimSafe rules application** (Workbook Section 4, Activity 6.1b) | Cannot recall most rules; cannot apply them to real situations | Recalls most SwimSafe rules accurately; applies them in at least one scenario | Recalls all 5 rules accurately; applies them across different waterway types; identifies which is most personally relevant and explains why with specificity |
| **Application to scenarios** | Responses are superficial; doesn't apply DRS ABCD or flag knowledge correctly | Applies most correct steps; some logical gaps in scenarios | Consistently applies correct procedures; clearly justifies decisions with reasoning; shows critical thinking |
| **Throw rescue & emergency response** (Activity 5.2, Section 3) | Unable to rank rescue options; does not understand why entering water is dangerous | Ranks rescue options mostly correctly; understands throw rescue principle; some gaps in DRS ABCD | Accurately ranks and justifies rescue hierarchy using RLSSA framework; applies DRS ABCD correctly; explains secondary drowning risk of untrained rescuers |
| **Personal action plan** | Generic or incomplete; 'I will be careful' type answers | Specific to own life; at least two realistic commitments; chosen scenario plan has most key elements | Highly specific, realistic, and personalised; shows genuine reflection on own habits and risks; action plan for chosen scenario is thorough and detailed |
| **Communication campaign task** | Incomplete; vague message; no clear audience; basic language | Clear message; appropriate for audience; includes one relevant fact with source; mostly correct | Compelling, audience-appropriate content; uses accurate data with source URL cited; clear call to action; demonstrates communication skills aligned to chosen format |

## ♿ 6. Differentiation & Inclusion

### 🌐 CALD (Culturally and Linguistically Diverse) Students

**Priority note:** CALD communities accounted for nearly 40% of Victorian drowning deaths in 2023–24 — the highest ever recorded, and 60% more likely per capita than the general population. This unit is particularly important for CALD students, and the communication campaign task is the highest-impact activity for community reach.

- LSV provides translated water safety resources in Arabic, Vietnamese, Chinese, Somali, and other languages: `https://lsv.com.au/community/multicultural-safety/`
- The Victorian Government's water safety page also has multilingual resources: `https://www.vic.gov.au/water-safety`
- Allow students to share culturally different relationships with water — not all cultures traditionally swim; validate diverse experiences while communicating the importance of learning water safety regardless of background.
- Pair CALD students with supportive peers for scenario activities; allow translation of key terms using home language or digital tools where helpful.
- **Communication Campaign Option C** (multilingual fact sheet) is specifically designed for CALD students — encourage them to create it in their home language. This is a highly meaningful task that extends reach into the community beyond the classroom.
- When discussing fishing-related drowning (more than half of fishing deaths in the past decade involve people from CALD backgrounds), handle with cultural sensitivity — frame as information, not judgment.
- If running Lesson 1 with a high-CALD cohort, be aware that some students may have direct family experience with water safety challenges related to cultural background and limited swimming opportunity.

### 📈 Extension Students (High Achieving)

- Assign **Extension Scenario Cards X1, X2, and X3** from the Scenario Activity Card pack. X1 is a full data analysis task comparing Victorian and national drowning data; X2 is the communication campaign; X3 investigates the physiology of drowning (cerebral hypoxia, CPR mechanics).
- Research task: Investigate how the LSV drowning report data compares to national data from Royal Life Saving Australia (https://www.royallifesaving.com.au/research). What are the key differences between Victorian and other state/territory rates?
- Design a school swim safety awareness week proposal, including activities, Poster 4 (SwimSafe) display, guest speakers from LSV, and RLSSA resources.

- Investigate the physiology of cold water shock using the 1-10-1 rule — write a summary for the school LMS or health notice board.
- Compare dry-land water safety education approaches between Australia (LSV/RLSSA), UK (RLSS UK), and USA (Red Cross). What are the key differences? Which approach do you think is most effective for teenagers? Cite sources from all three organisations.
- **Gamification extension:** Run **all 14 Scenario Cards** as a timed group challenge — groups compete to correctly answer the most scenarios. Teacher uses the on-screen answer reveals. Works well as an end-of-unit review or for a double lesson.

### ♿ Students with Additional Needs

- Workbook activities can be completed verbally with a scribe or using speech-to-text tools.
- CPR practical component: students with physical limitations can observe and provide verbal guidance to a partner — full marks available for verbal accuracy without physical demonstration.
- Simplified answer scaffolds can be provided for written questions (sentence starters, word banks, visual cue cards).
- For the Communication Campaign (Activity 6.2), the oral option — explaining to the teacher or presenting to a small group — is a valid and fully assessable alternative to written options.
- The SwimSafe 5 rules (Poster 4) make a strong visual memory support — laminate a personal copy for students who benefit from visual cues.
- Scenario Cards can be adapted — provide fewer questions per card, or pre-select the 5 most accessible cards for targeted use.

### 🏊 Non-Swimmers and Students Who Avoid Water

- This unit is deliberately fully classroom-based and dry-land. No student should feel embarrassed about swimming ability levels at any point.
- Activity 1.1 (swimming ability self-rating) is for the student's personal reflection only — do not ask students to share this publicly.
- Frame the unit message consistently: *"Being water smart isn't about being a great swimmer — it's about making safe decisions before and after you get near water. The data shows that knowing what to do saves lives."*
- The SwimSafe rules and DRS ABCD are equally important for non-swimmers — in fact, recognising dangerous situations *before* entering water is arguably the most important skill for a non-swimmer to develop.
- For students who have had negative water experiences, the Communication Campaign Option B (letter to younger student) allows them to process and share knowledge without requiring personal disclosure.

## 🎓 7. Teacher Background Knowledge

### 🌊 Key Water Safety Facts for Teachers

- **The 1-10-1 rule (cold water):** You have approximately 1 minute to control your breathing when you enter cold water, 10 minutes of useful swimming ability before your muscles lose coordination, and up to 1 hour of survival time before hypothermia sets in (in most adult adults).
- **Rip currents:** Account for approximately 80% of lifeguard rescues at Australian beaches. They are NOT undertows (which don't exist) — they move laterally, not down. They are actually calmer-looking water between breaking waves.
- **CPR rates:** Bystander CPR doubles or triples survival rates for cardiac arrest. Every second counts — CPR should start within 4 minutes of a cardiac arrest to give the best chance of brain function being preserved.
- **Throw, don't go:** Most non-professional bystander drownings occur when a friend or family member attempts an in-water rescue without training. A throw rescue with any floating object from the bank is always safer.
- **AEDs:** Automated External Defibrillators are in many public spaces in Victoria (pools, shopping centres, schools). They are designed to be used by untrained bystanders — the device will not shock a heart that doesn't need it. Know where your school's AED is located before teaching this unit.

📌 KNOW YOUR SCHOOL'S EMERGENCY PLAN

Before teaching this unit, ensure you know: (1) where your school's AED is located, (2) your school's emergency response protocol for water-related incidents at excursions, (3) the wellbeing referral pathway if a student shares personal trauma related to drowning. Review the DE Swimming and Water Safety policy annually.

## 🔗 8. Resources & Sources

### 🎓 Victorian Curriculum (VCAA)

HPE Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0, content descriptions and achievement standards

https://f10.vcaa.vic.edu.au/health-and-physical-education/curriculum/f-10

### 🏊 Life Saving Victoria (LSV)

Primary Victorian resource. Drowning reports, classroom lessons, SwimSafe program, multicultural resources, LSV Toolkit — all free and VCAA-aligned

https://lsv.com.au
https://lsv.com.au/toolkit/classroom_based_water_safety.php
https://lsv.com.au/community/multicultural-safety/

### 📊 LSV Annual Drowning Reports

Updated annually. 2023–24 report: 54 deaths, all at unpatrolled locations. Essential for Workbook Section 1 data activities.

https://lsv.com.au/research/victorian-drowning-reports/

### 🏅 Royal Life Saving Society Australia (RLSSA)

Swim & Survive program, Bronze e-Lifesaving, classroom dry-land modules, throw rescue hierarchy guidelines. Used for Workbook Activity 5.2.

https://www.royallifesaving.com.au
https://www.drowningprevention.org.au/swimandsurvive

### 🚣 Paddle Australia

Inland waterway safety for rivers, lakes, and moving water — critical Victorian context. Used for Workbook Activity 5.1c research task and kayaking action plan option.

https://paddle.org.au

### 🌿 Parks Victoria

Victorian natural environment waterway hazards — localised content for Yarra River, Alpine regions, national parks. Excellent for scenario-based classroom activities.

https://www.park.vic.gov.au

### 🎓 AUSTSWIM

National swimming teacher training. Frameworks for lesson design, skill progression, inclusion strategies. Useful for planning CPR and rescue skill components.

https://austswim.com.au

### 🚤 BeachSafe App (SLSA)

Free app showing patrolled beaches, patrol hours, conditions. Student task: find nearest 3 patrolled beaches. Used in Lessons 2 and 4.

https://beachsafe.org.au

### 🏄 Surf Life Saving Australia

Rip current videos, beach safety education, volunteer information. Video recommended for Lesson 2 rip current explanation.

https://sls.com.au/surf-safety/rip-currents/

### 🩺 St John Ambulance Victoria

CPR & DRS ABCD resources, first aid fact sheets, free printable guides. Central to Lesson 3 content.

https://www.stjohnvic.com.au/first-aid-resources/

### 🏛 Victorian Government Water Safety

Multilingual resources, beach water quality forecasts, inland waterway guidance, Play it Safe by the Water program.

https://www.vic.gov.au/water-safety
https://www.police.vic.gov.au/beach-and-waterways-safety

### 🏫 DE Swimming & Water Safety Policy

Mandatory policy for all Victorian government schools. Covers curriculum requirements, funding, excursion guidelines, and the School Swimming Toolkit.

https://www2.education.vic.gov.au/pal/swimming-instruction-and-water-safety-education/policy

### 📖 VCAA HPE Teaching Resources

Sample F–10 swimming and water safety activities aligned to Curriculum 2.0, achievement standards, and assessment strategies.

https://www.vcaa.vic.edu.au/curriculum/foundation-10/curriculum-area-resources/health-and-physical-education/teaching-resources

### 🌊 LSV + VCAA Progressions Guide

Swimming and Water Safety F–10 Progression Model — competency expectations at every curriculum level, co-developed by LSV and VCAA.

https://lsv.com.au/toolkit/curriculum_more.php

**GB RLSS UK — Education Resources**

International classroom lesson plans, water safety scenarios, rescue decision-making frameworks. Free downloads. Good for extension comparison tasks.

https://www.rlss.org.uk/education

**US American Red Cross — Water Safety**

"Think So You Don't Sink" decision-making model. Engaging videos for teens. Good for cross-referencing with Australian data in Extension Card X1.

https://www.redcross.org/take-a-class/water-safety

**US CDC Drowning Prevention**

US public health drowning data and prevention research. Strong for numeracy-linked cross-curricular comparison tasks (Extension Card X1).

https://www.cdc.gov/drowning/prevention

**📰 LSV Blog — Curriculum 2.0**

LSV explanation of changes under Victorian Curriculum 2.0 and what they mean for school HPE programs.

https://blog.lsv.com.au/2025/07/09/swimming-and-water-safety-in-the-new-victorian-curriculum-f-10-2-0/

## 📚 Suggested Videos for Classroom Use

- **LSV 'Watch and Learn' Water Safety Series** (classroom-ready, curriculum-linked): https://lsv.com.au/toolkit/classroom_based_water_safety.php
- **SLSA Rip Current Education** (recommended Lesson 2 video, ~4 min): https://sls.com.au/surf-safety/rip-currents/
- **Victoria Police Beach & Waterways Safety**: https://www.police.vic.gov.au/beach-and-waterways-safety
- **RLSSA Cold Water Safety** (recommended Lesson 4): Search "Royal Life Saving cold water shock" on YouTube or visit https://www.royallifesaving.com.au
- **Red Cross water safety videos** (engaging for teens, good for Lesson 4): https://www.redcross.org/take-a-class/water-safety

## 📦 Your Complete Package — File Summary

| File | Purpose | Primary Use |
|---|---|---|
| swim_safety_poster_pack | 4 A3 classroom posters (DRS ABCD, Beach Flags, Drowning Stats, SwimSafe Rules) | Display during unit; visual reference throughout all lessons |
| swim_safety_student_workbook | 6-section student workbook with ~35 activities | Distributed to students; used across all 5 lessons; collected as summative evidence |
| swim_safety_teacher_workbook | This document — lesson plans, answer key, rubric, differentiation, resources | Teacher planning and delivery reference; not for student distribution |
| water_safety_resource_directory | 11 organisations with descriptions, dry-land applicability notes, and verified URLs | Teacher reference; share with HPE faculty; use for planning additional units |
| water_safety_scenario_cards | 14 printable scenario cards (Beach, River, Pool, Emergency, Decision-Making) + 3 extension cards | Print and laminate; use as station activities, pair tasks, or quick-fire review games |
| water_safety_assessment_gradebook | 4-tab interactive tool: full A–E rubric, curriculum alignment, class tracker, report comment generator | Assessment and reporting; generate Victorian Curriculum-aligned report comments |